



The Populele U1

The Populele U1 is a smart ukulele with a light-up fret board and a companion app that pairs over Bluetooth. <http://dgit.in/Populele>

Steadicam Volt stabilizer

Steadicam Volt Stabilizer is a new smartphone gimbal that uses electronic motor system to steady your shots. <http://dgit.in/VoltCam>

Industry Connect

Ryzen, Vega, Instinct, and more...

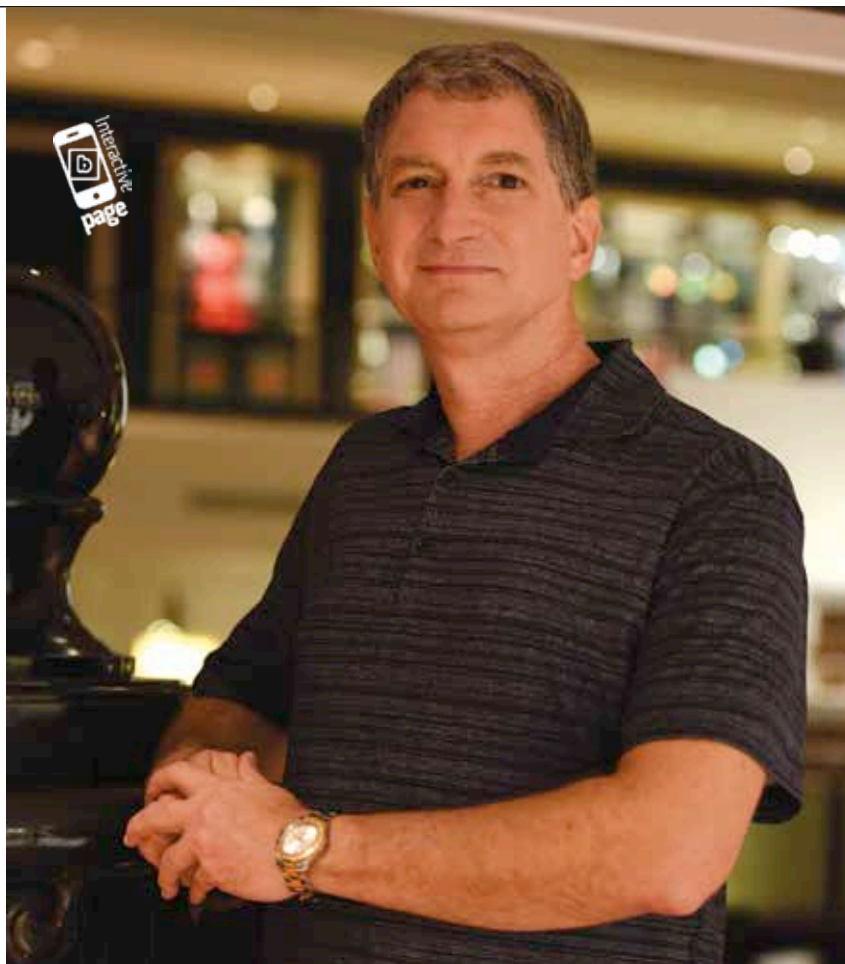
AMD has a busy year ahead. We sit down with Mark Papermaster, CTO, AMD to learn more.

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d AMD has undergone quite a few changes over the years. There was the separation of AMD and RTG. Then the fabs in South-East Asia were sold to another company. There seems to be a lot of restructuring happening. So how is AMD shaping its direction?

Mark: Well, we started restructuring about five years ago. It started with redirection in terms of our energies and R&D. There's a long lead time for brand new technologies. So we started our redirection with our new team and a new high-performance core which we're rolling out into the market as Zen. And then really retooling a lot of the engineering, first under Zen core, then our graphics products and even the technologies by how we put CPU graphics in our other IPs to get what we call our Infinity Fabric. So this started some years ago, and each year we've been able to make excellent progress in development. And this has lead up to our focus on graphics through the formation of Radeon Technology Group as you mentioned.

In terms of China, that's more about addressing the market. We have partnerships with the Chinese Academy of Sciences for the microprocessor effort. As for Tianjin, we've allowed a partnership that will create a product that was sanctioned by the government to really reach deeper into the market which is restricted to indigenous design. And then we had divested parts of our pack and assembly, and the fabs some time



Mark Papermaster, CTO, AMD

ago. Now that the industry OSAT is quite developed, it was no longer necessary to keep pack and assembly as part of our assembly so we entered into a partnership with Nantong Fujitsu. So that's also been going quite well.

d AMD has been dominating the console segment with the current generation. And with the move from proprietary architecture to x86, consoles are becoming more similar to PCs. So would AMD continue to target semi-custom SoCs or would consoles simply use the same chip-sets as the PC segment does?

Mark: The beauty of our semi-custom market is that it leverages technologies from the AMD road map. So we have a strong technology road map for our CPUs, graphics, video and display technology, multimedia and so on. That's what we use to create our Radeon products, our CPUs, our APUs. So, of

course, we'll compete. For future opportunities in the game console segment, we'll again compete to win based on the strength of the technology roadmap that we have at AMD.

d When you demonstrated Ryzen back in August, it was clocked at 3 GHz and later at the unveiling it was demonstrated at 3.4 GHz. Could you tell us what the final base and boost clocks will be?

Mark: We were just trying to show our customers that we are right on track. That being said, we'll be completing the Zen core design this year, completing test and getting it to market in Q1 as Ryzen. We're really trying to show the capability of Ryzen, that we can compete with Intel's i7, that we can compete with the highest end CPU in the market today. Ryzen is designed to address the full range of the marketplace. **d**

Full interview - <http://dgit.in/AMDMarkCTO>